Kubernetes Commands Cheat Sheet

Basic Cluster & Context

Command	What it does	Important Flags	Flag Description
`kubectl version`	Shows client & server version	`--short`	Short output
`kubectl cluster-info`	Displays cluster info	—	—
`kubectl config get-contexts`	Lists all contexts	—	—
`kubectl config use-context <name>`	Switch context	—	—
`kubectl config current-context`	Shows current context	—	—

Pods

Command	What it does	Important Flags	Flag Description
`kubectl get pods`	List pods	`-o wide`	More details (IP, node)
		`-A`	All namespaces
`kubectl describe pod <pod>`	Detailed pod info	—	—
`kubectl logs <pod>`	Show logs	`-f`	Follow logs
		`--tail=50`	Last 50 lines
`kubectl exec -it <pod> -- bash`	Access container shell	`-c <container>`	Specify container
`kubectl delete pod <pod>`	Delete pod	`--grace-period=0 --force`	Force delete

Deployments

Command	What it does	Important Flags	Flag Description
`kubectl get deployments`	List deployments	`-A`	All namespaces
`kubectl create deployment <name> --image=<img>`	Create deployment	`--replicas=3`	Set replicas
`kubectl scale deployment <name>`	Scale deployment	`--replicas=5`	Number of pods
`kubectl rollout status deployment <name>`	Check rollout	—	—
`kubectl rollout undo deployment <name>`	Rollback deployment	—	—

Services

Command	What it does	Important Flags	Flag Description
`kubectl get svc`	List services	—	—
`kubectl expose deployment <name>`	Create service	`--type=NodePort`	Service type
		`--port=80`	Service port
		`--target-port=8080`	Container port
`kubectl describe svc <name>`	Service details	—	—

Namespaces

Command	What it does	Important Flags	Flag Description
`kubectl get ns`	List namespaces	—	—
`kubectl create ns <name>`	Create namespace	—	—
`kubectl delete ns <name>`	Delete namespace	—	—
`kubectl get pods -n <ns>`	Pods in namespace	—	—

Nodes

Command	What it does	Important Flags	Flag Description
`kubectl get nodes`	List nodes	`-o wide`	Extra details
`kubectl describe node <node>`	Node info	—	—
`kubectl cordon <node>`	Mark node unschedulable	—	—
`kubectl uncordon <node>`	Enable scheduling	—	—
`kubectl drain <node>`	Evacuate pods	`--ignore-daemonsets`	Skip daemonsets

Config & Secrets

Command	What it does	Important Flags	Flag Description
`kubectl create configmap <name>`	Create configmap	`--from-literal=key=value`	Inline data
`kubectl get configmap`	List configmaps	—	—
`kubectl create secret generic <name>`	Create secret	`--from-literal=key=value`	Inline secret
`kubectl get secrets`	List secrets	—	—

Apply & Files

Command	What it does	Important Flags	Flag Description
`kubectl apply -f file.yaml`	Apply config	`-R`	Recursive
`kubectl delete -f file.yaml`	Delete resources	—	—
`kubectl diff -f file.yaml`	Show changes	—	—
`kubectl replace -f file.yaml`	Replace resource	—	—

Debugging & Monitoring

Command	What it does	Important Flags	Flag Description
`kubectl top pods`	Resource usage (pods)	—	Metrics server required
`kubectl top nodes`	Node usage	—	—
`kubectl get events`	Cluster events	`--sort-by=.metadata.creationTimestamp`	Sort events
`kubectl describe`	Debug any resource	—	Works for all

Labels & Selectors

Command	What it does	Important Flags	Flag Description
`kubectl label pods <pod> key=value`	Add label	`--overwrite`	Replace existing
`kubectl get pods -l key=value`	Filter by label	—	—

Port Forwarding

Command	What it does	Important Flags	Flag Description
`kubectl port-forward pod/<pod> 8080:80`	Forward port	—	Local:Remote
`kubectl port-forward svc/<svc> 8080:80`	Forward service	—	—

Quick Power Moves

Command	What it does
`kubectl get all`	Everything in namespace
`kubectl delete all --all`	Delete everything
`kubectl api-resources`	List resource types
`kubectl explain <resource>`	Docs inside terminal

Pro Tips (Real Dev Stuff)

• Use aliases:

```
alias k=kubectl
```

• Auto-completion:

```
source <(kubectl completion bash)
```

• Dry run before applying:

```
kubectl apply -f file.yaml --dry-run=client
```